

Justin Malčić

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Rails engineer with two years' experience, with Rails since university. Owned a Hotwire application end-to-end as sole engineer, working with the grain of the framework.

Experience

Building Atlas

Software Engineer May 2024 – June 2026

Sole Rails engineer on a retrofit decision-support platform for commercial property portfolios.

- While upgrading to Rails 8.1, found regression breaking signed URLs for GCS, traced to a faulty assumption in a recently merged Rails PR, submitted correct fix to Rails, fix merged.
 - Encountered rendering bugs with ApexCharts, evaluated alternatives, and concluded that JS-rendered charts would always require defending against Turbo's rendering lifecycle rather than working with it; planned and executed a phased migration to a server-side responsive SVG approach, published as an open source gem.
 - Delivered multi-tenant portfolio switching using Rack middleware adapted from Fizzy and a non-persisting impersonation object for superuser access, so internal users can never silently acquire permissions that would weaken customer access guarantees.
 - Independently designed and built an AI assistant for querying customer data conversationally, with an extensible tool layer using schema introspection to validate queries before execution, preventing the agent from misreading results of incorrect queries as absent data.
 - Replaced Selenium with Playwright after persistent flakiness with Turbo's partial page replacement, containerised as a local executable to avoid Ruby/JS version sync issues; kept all critical paths functional without JS so tests could cover them without depending on client-side integration.
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Education

Imperial College London

MSc Computing 2022–2023 Merit

Individual project: AST-aware version control system in Rust, tracking syntax mutations in a language-independent format via Language Server APIs.

University of Maryland

MA Linguistics 2019–2022 4.0 GPA

University of Cambridge

BA Linguistics 2016–2019 First class

Volunteer software work: Hack Cambridge (Express/Postgres backend and frontend); conference management system in Rails for ULAB.

Skills

Languages

Ruby, Rust, JavaScript, SQL

Frameworks and infrastructure

Ruby on Rails, Hotwire, PostgreSQL, Tailwind, GCP

Spoken languages

French, German, Italian (C1)